Session 2: What is a Serial?

- What is the definition of a serial?
- What are the common characteristics of serials?
- What types of publications are or are not typically cataloged as serials?
- What MARC tags are most commonly used for serials?

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Dictionary Definition of Serial

A publication issued as one of a consecutively numbered and indefinitely continued series.

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Definition of a Serial

A continuing resource

– issued in a succession of discrete parts

– usually bearing numbering

– that has no predetermined conclusion

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Important Elements of the Definition

- Succession of discrete parts (necessary)
- Numbering (usually)
- No predetermined conclusion (necessary)

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Also Treat as Serials:

Publications of limited duration (AACR2 12.0A)

- Have similar characteristics and functions of serials but have a predetermined conclusion
- Examples: Newsletters from conferences, quarterly reports of projects, etc.

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Identifying Characteristics

- ISSN:
  1096-6919
  0895-495X
- Frequency in title:
  AB Bookman's weekly
  Annual report of the Academy of Sciences of Estonia
  Yachting monthly

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Identifying Characteristics

- Enumeration/chronology:
  - Volume 28
  - Vol. 32, No. 10 September 1997
  - Spring 1997
  - 1998-1
- Year(s) of coverage:
  - 1997 (item published in 1998)
  - ... for the fiscal year 1995
  - ... covering the period July 1978 through June 1979

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Identifying Characteristics

- Intent to continue publishing:

  Preface:

  The inaugural issue of Advances in the Theory of Computation and Computational Mathematics ... Future volumes of ATCCM ...

- Certain titles:
  - **Advances in** accounting
  - **Developments in** aging
  - **Progress in** theoretical organic chemistry
  - **Trends in** African linguistics

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Non-serials: Print Monographs (RI 1.0C)

- Books issued in parts (fascicles)
- Cartographic materials (most)
- Censuses
- Encyclopedias
- Hearings
- Five-year plans

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Non-serials: Integrating Resources

- Updating Web sites
- Updating online databases
- Updating loose-leafs

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Special Types of Resources

Frequently issued editions:

Catalog as a serial only when published every year or two; otherwise treat as monograph

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Special Types of Resources

Conference publications

- Catalog as serial if it fits the definition of a serial

  The 48th Annual Meeting of the National Athletic Trainer's Association

  Conference Proceedings, Animal Transportation Association 17th International Conference, September 29-October 2, 1991

- Do not catalog as a serial if there are distinctive titles or if conference publication is published in a numbered series

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Conference Publications

Split treatment:

500 -- $a Issues for 1993-1995 conferences cataloged separately. $5 [MARC21 inst. code]

500 -- $a Beginning with the 5th conference, issues are cataloged separately. $5 [MARC21 inst. code]

or

590 -- $a Issues for 1993-1995 conferences cataloged separately.

590 -- $a Beginning with the 5th conference, issues are cataloged separately.

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Resources Issued in Loose-leaf Format

- Catalog as serial if:
  - Resource is a serial whose successive issues are stored in a binder
  - Base volume is regularly issued (e.g., annual with updates during the year)
- Catalog as an integrating resource if:
  - Updates are interfiled and base volume is irregularly revised

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Supplements

Supplements may be separately cataloged as serials when they have their own title and/or numbering

Opportunity magazine
Vol. 1, no. 1 (Jan. 1923)-

The Annual buyers' guide of $uccess $ecrets
1997-

Public health reports
Vol. 11, no. 1 (Jan. 3, 1896)-v. 85, no. 12 (Dec. 1970)

Supplement … to the Public health reports
No. 1-no. 213

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Reprints of Serials

Catalog as serials unless the reprint includes only a single issue or a collection of unrelated serials

Serial: Black Mountain review. Reprint, with an introduction added, of a publication issued (quarterly 1954, annually 1955-1957) in Black Mountain, N.C. by the Black Mountain College and edited by Robert Creely.

Monograph: Prague spring. A collection of articles from newspapers published in Czechoslovakia during the years 1966-1968.

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Monographic Series

Series may be cataloged as a serial or each issue of the series may be cataloged separately

Abraham Lincoln
The First American

By Gordon B. Baldwin

Historical Bulletin No. 42
Lincoln Fellowship of Wisconsin

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Change of Issuance over Time

- What begins as a multipart monograph may become …
- What begins as an integrating resource may become …
- What begins as an serial may become …

Differences between, Changes within. Chicago: ALCTS, 2007.
http://www.ala.org/ala/alctscontent/alctspubsbucket/webpublications/cataloging/newrecord/differences.htm

"Changes in a bibliographic resource's mode of issuance"
http://www.loc.gov/catdir/cpso/modeissu.html

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MARC Tagging and Serials

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Serial MARC Record

The serial 008 fixed field includes:

Type	a	ELvl		Srce	d	GPub		Ctrl		Lang	eng
BLvl	**s**	Form		Conf	■	**Freq**	■	MRec		Ctry	enk
S/L	**0**	Orig	■	EntW		**Regl**	■	Alph			
Desc	a	**SrTp**	**p**	Cont		**DtSt**	**c**	Dates 1920,9999			

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Serial MARC Record

0XX Variable Fields:

010 -- $a 98659124 $z sc83001761
022 -- $a 0043-9983
037 -- $b IPC Magazines Ltd., King's Beach Tower, Stamford Street, London SE1 9LS
042 -- $a lc $a nsdp
050 00 $a GV771 $b .Y3

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Serial MARC Record

Title Fields::

210 0 - $a Yacht. mon.
222 - 4 $a The Yachting monthly
245 04 $a The yachting monthly.
246 13 $a Yachting

Publication Information:

260 -- $a [London : $b Yachting Monthly], $c 1920-
300 -- $a v. : $b ill. ; $c 28 cm. [CSR: optional]

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Serial MARC Record

Frequency:

310 -- $a Monthly

Designation:

362 1- $a Began with v. 29, no. 166 (Feb. 1920).

Notes:

500 -- $a Description based on v. 29, no. 166 (Feb. 1920); title from cover.
500 -- $a Published: IPC Magazines Ltd., 1991-
500 -- $a Latest issue consulted: Vol. 160, no. 2 (May 1998).

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Serial MARC Record

Subject Headings:

650 -0 $a Yachting $v Periodicals.

Links:

780 00 $t Yachting monthly and magazine of the R.N.V.R. $w (OCoLC)13484999 $w (DLC)sn 86032453

776 08 $i Online version: $t Yachting monthly online $x … $w ...

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Summary

- Three criteria for serials: successive parts, numbering, no predetermined conclusion
- Certain resources require special considerations relating to access, control, etc.
- When unsure, review LCRI 1.0, search for records on databases, consider the needs of your library
- MARC tags for serials include special note fields and linking fields

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